

Chapter-5

SIMPLE AND COMPLEX SENTENCES

1 Types of Sentences:

Sentences are of three types:

1. Simple Sentences
2. Compound Sentences
3. Complex Sentences

- (i) **Simple Sentence :** A sentence which has only *one* subject and *one* predicate is known as a Simple Sentence.

For Example :

<u>My sister</u>	<u>works very hard.</u>
Subject	Predicate

<u>Three of the students</u>	<u>were absent.</u>
Subject	Predicate

- (ii) **Compound Sentence :** A Compound Sentence is composed of two or more *co-ordinate* clauses.

For Example :

<u>Gurpreet loves Mathematics</u>	but	<u>Simran hates it.</u>
Co-ordinate clause		Co-ordinate clause

In this compound sentence, two co-ordinate clauses 'Gurpreet loves Mathematics' and 'Simran hates it' are joined by the co-ordinate conjunction *but*.

- (iii) **Complex Sentence :** A Complex Sentence is composed of two or more clauses. One of the clauses in a complex Sentence is more important than the other/others. The more important clause is called the Main Clause or the Principal Clause. The less important clause/ clauses is/are called the Subordinate or Dependent Clause/Clauses.

For Example :

<u>I know a man</u>	<u>who lives in Canada.</u>
Principal Clause	Subordinate Clause

The sentence given above is made up of two parts (clauses) each having a subject and a predicate of its own.

For example :

1. I know a man
2. who lives in Canada.

Clause 2, by itself, does not make a complete sense. For its meaning, it depends upon Clause 1. As shown above, Clause 1 is the Principal Clause and Clause 2 is the Subordinate Clause.

Here is an example of a Complex Sentence which contains one Principal Clause and two Subordinate Clauses.

For example:

<u>I know a man</u>	<u>who sells oranges</u>	<u>where the two roads meet.</u>
Principal Clause	Subordinate Clause (I)	Subordinate Clause (II)
<i>Principal Clause</i>	:	I know a man
<i>Subordinate Clause I</i>	:	who sells oranges
<i>Subordinate Clause II</i>	:	where the two roads meet

Exercise 1

Specify whether the following sentences are simple or complex :

1. God helps those who help themselves.
2. The teacher said that the earth moves around the sun.
3. The boy standing under the tree works very hard.
4. When it rains, we do not play.
5. The doctor advised the patient to give up drinking.
6. She went to the doctor because she had pain in her stomach.
7. She worked hard so that she should top the list.
8. There are seven days in a week.
9. All the good students in our school talk in English.
10. All the good teachers who teach us talk in Punjabi.

2. Types of Subordinate Clauses :

Subordinate Clauses can be divided into three types:

1. Noun Clauses
2. Adjective Clauses
3. Adverb Clauses

(i) **Noun Clause :** A Noun Clause functions as a noun in a Complex Sentence. It generally occupies the place of the subject or the object as illustrated in the following sentences :

(a) Subject of a verb :

That Simran is honest is a fact.

Subject

Whoever spoke on the stage was given a prize.

Subject

(b) Object of a verb :

Tell me where the doctor lives

Object

I understand that he needs money very badly.

Subject

(c) Complement of a be-type verb :

The truth is

Be-type verb

that he does not love you.

object

The reality was

Be-type verb

that she loved only money.

object

(d) Object of a preposition:

She agreed to

Preposition

what I said.

object

We cannot rely upon

Preposition

What she says

object

(e) Object of an infinitive :

We were glad to learn

infinitive phrase

that India had won the match.

object

I am unable to understand

infinitive phrase

why she did not go home.

object

(f) Object of a participle :

I went to the teacher finding

(participle)

that I could not solve the sum myself.

object

We did not visit him learning

(participle)

that he was down with fever.

object

Exercise 2

Pick out the Noun Clauses in each of the following sentences :

1. Please tell me where I can find good sweaters.
2. She hopes that she will pass this year.
3. You should understand why you failed last year.
4. He does not know what harm can come to him.
5. We do not know how she completed such a difficult job.

6. When the train will arrive is not certain.
7. I did not reply to what she said.
8. We visited her knowing that she had met with an accident.
9. I was very glad to get what I wanted.
10. The truth is that most people are after money.

ii) Adjective Clause :

An Adjective Clause functions as an Adjective. Therefore, it qualifies a noun or pronoun in some other clause. Adjective Clauses, are introduced in two ways :

- (1) By relative pronouns like *who, whose, whom, which, that* etc.

For Example : (a) She is the girl who came first.
Principal Clause Subordinate Clause

(b) I know the persons whose houses were destroyed.
Principal Clause Subordinate Clause

Functioning as Adjective Clause

(c) This is the town to which he came then.
Principal Clause Adjective Clause

(d) The boy who is in a red shirt is the monitor.
Adjective Clause

Principal Clause : The boy is the monitor.

Adjective Clause : who is in a red shirt.

(e) This is the same book as was badly needed by Asha.
Principal Clause Adjective Clause

- (2) By relative adverb like *when, how* etc :

(a) This is the time when he wakes up in the morning.
Main Clause Subordinate Clause functioning as
Adjective Clause

(b) Tell me the way how I can improve my English .
Main Clause Adjective Clause

Exercise 3

Pick out the Adjective Clause in each of the following sentences :

1. The girl whose father is a doctor lives here.
2. God helps those who help themselves.
3. The book I bought yesterday is missing.
4. This is the same story as my sister told me yesterday.
5. I have found the books which you lost yesterday.

6. Papa forgot to tell us the time when he would return.
7. This is the school where Raju got education.
8. Greed for money is a long road that has no end.
9. That was the film that I liked the most.
10. The hand that rocks the cradle rules the world.

(iii) Adverb Clause :

An Adverb Clause functions as an Adverb. It functions to modify a Verb, an Ajective or an Adverb.

An Adverb Clause may express one of the following :

1. Clause or Reason : An Adverb clause of reason begins with *because, since, for, as etc.*
 - (a) She could not meet me then because she was teaching.
 - (b) I cannot attend school for I am down with malaria.
2. Time : An adverb clause of time is introduced by *when, after, before, until, as long as, while etc.*
 - (a) Please telephone me as soon as you reach home.
 - (b) You must wash your hands before you eat breakfast.
3. Purpose : An adverb clause of purpose begins with *so that, in order that, lest, should etc.*
 - (a) He joined the boarding school so that he could study well.
 - (b) Don't touch the live electric wire, lest you should die.
4. Condition : An adverb clause of condition begins with *if, in case, provided that etc.*
 - (a) I cannot go out unless mother allows me to do.
 - (b) If you want to keep fit, take exercise daily.
5. Place : An adverb clause of place begins with *where, wherever, whence etc.*
 - (a) My dog will follow me wherever I go.
 - (b) Nobody knows whence he came.
6. Manner of Extent : An adverb clause of Manner or Extent is introduced by *as if, as though, as far as, so far etc.*
 - (a) He is walking as if he were lame.
 - (b) As far as I know, he has left Ludhiana.
7. Contrast as Concession : An Adverb clause of concession or contrast begins with *though, even if, however, whatever, notwithstanding etc.*
Although he is very rich, he hardly spends any money.
However fast you run, you cannot catch the train.
8. Comparison : An adverb clause of comparison begins with *than, as much as, no less than etc.*

- (a) Girls are not generally so tall as boys.
- (b) I am more intelligent than your sister.

Effect or Result : An adverb clause of effect or result begins with
so + adverb + that, such + adverb + that.

- (a) He drove so slow that we could not reach on time.
 - (b) The girl sings so well that nobody helps clapping for her.
9. Proportion : An Adverb clause of proportion begins with *The + comparative degree of Adjective or Adverb.*
- (a) The deeper the well. the sweeter the water.
 - (b) The earlier she starts, the better it will be.

Exercise 4

Pick out the Adjective Clause in each of the following sentences :

1. The tighter the belt, the smarter the person.
2. In case it rains, we shall play indoor games.
3. He woke up early so that he could catch the train.
4. I will join a college even if my parents are against it.
5. Look before you leap.
6. There is no need to worry as long as you are working hard.
7. As time went by, he saved a lot of money.
8. He reached the station after the train had left.
9. I'll put it where no one will see it.
10. I met him as he was coming from college.

Exercise 5

Combine the following sentences using an adverb clause in each case :

1. He injured himself. He was alighting from the bus. (use *as* or *while*)
2. The platform became quiet. The train had left. (use *when* or *after*)
3. Arrange these books. I have shown you. (use *as*)
4. I was very upset. I felt like crying. (use *so+adj+that*)
5. Your brother is tall. My brother is taller. (use *than*)
6. You finish the work early. We can play tennis. (use *if*)
7. It was raining cats and dogs. They were playing football. (use *although*)
8. Mohan should start very early. It will be better. (use *the earlier, the better*)
9. My brother could not do homework. There was no power last night. (use *because*)
10. She dances extremely well. You cannot help clapping. (use *so... that*)

Exercise 6

Transform the following sentences into complex ones without changing the meaning.

1. I don't know his house. (use *when*)
2. She said something and I could not hear it. (use *what*)
3. Some people help themselves and God helps them. (use *who*)
4. The boy is very intelligent and his father is a doctor. (use *whose*)
5. This box is too heavy for me to lift. (use *so... that*)
6. I wish to be rich. (use *were*)
7. My father went to my school to meet my headmaster. (use *so that*)
8. Taking off his coat, Simran jumped into the canal. (use *after*)
9. Mohan is old but strong. (use *although*)
10. A parentless child is called an orphan. (use *who*)

Exercise 7

Transform the following into Simple Sentences :

1. He promised that he would return the money soon.
2. That Mohan will win the race is certain.
3. She did not tell us who helped her.
4. What is one man's meat is another man's poison.
5. She may accept the suggestion given by Surjeet.
6. The sum was so difficult that nobody was able to do it.
7. We selected this plan because it was easy.
8. This is the reason why he refused to help us.
9. He is studying hard because he wants to become a doctor.
10. A professor earns respect as he has a lot of knowledge.

Exercise 8

Pick out the Noun Clauses in each of the following sentences :

1. That he is dead is true.
2. None knows where he lives.
3. That he will soon be killed is certain.
4. He promised that he would return the book after use.
5. I do not know when he left the place.
6. This is exactly what I expect of you.
7. He little knows what harm can come to him.
8. Nobody knows who did this mischief.

9. I wonder why there is a strike today.
10. The problem is how the refugees can be helped.

Exercise 9

Pick out the Adjective Clauses in each of the following sentences :

1. He killed the snake that bit his wife.
2. We may accept the offer he has made.
3. This is the garden in which we used to play.
4. I know the boy whose books were stolen yesterday.
5. I remember the house where I was born.
6. Youth is the time when seeds of character are sown.
7. Please tell me the story that everyday has liked so much.
8. There was not a man who laughed.
9. The place where he was born is still unknown.
10. The boy who stole the watch was caught.

Exercise 10

Pick out the Adverb Clauses in each of the following sentences:

1. He went home as soon as the school closed.
2. The boys work while the teacher is in the room.
3. You may come whenever you please.
4. She talks as if she were mad.
5. As far as I know, he is quite honest.
6. I could not come yesterday because I was ill.
7. I shall go out for a walk even if it rains.
8. After the play ended, we sang the national anthem.
9. Grapes won't grow where there is heavy rainfall.
10. She is as pretty as a doll.